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MARCS IT Policy

Statewide Interoperability TalkGroups

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1.0 Purpose

To set forth the minimum set of interoperable talkgroups to be required in all public safety and public works radios that operate on the State of Ohio MARCS radio system.

2.0 Scope

Existing radios shall be brought into compliance at the next user scheduled radio programming change. All new radios shall meet the minimum interoperability requirements upon being placed in service. All talkgroups shall follow the MARCS P25 Talkgroup numbering and naming policy.

3.0 Background

The Multi-Agency Radio Communication System (MARCS) has developed a Statewide Interoperability Template so that each radio on the system is able to communicate with all other radios on the system in event of an emergency. While it would be ideal to have all interoperability talkgroups in all radios, that is not always possible or practical. MARCS has taken a “Must Have”, “Better”, and “Best” approach to the interoperability template.

4.0 Radio Capacity

Each zone of interoperability talkgroups will be ranked into groups and those talkgroups added to the radio after the radio has met any local requirements (i.e., if the radio only has a 48 talkgroup/channel capacity and the local requirement takes 32 talkgroups/channels, the remaining sixteen (16) shall be used for interoperability talkgroups/channels). The location of the interoperability zones in the radio are at the user agency’s discretion.

5.0 “Must Have” TalkGroups

At a minimum, all public safety radios shall have the following interoperability zone loaded in their radios. Usage of these talkgroups is controlled by the MARCS Help Desk at 1-866-646-2727.

XECOMM1	XECOMM5	XECOMM9	XECOMM13
XECOMM2	XECOMM6	XECOMM10	XECOMM14
XECOMM3	XECOMM7	XECOMM11	XECOMM15
XECOMM4	XECOMM8	XECOMM12	XECOMM16

All public works radios shall have the following interoperability zone loaded in their radios.

XMARCS1	XMARCS5	XMARCS9	XMARCS13
XMARCS2	XMARCS6	XMARCS10	XMARCS14
XMARCS3	XMARCS7	XMARCS11	XMARCS15
XMARCS4	XMARCS8	XMARCS12	XMARCS16

6.0 Better TalkGroup Plan

If possible, all public safety radios should have the following “Better” list of interoperability zones loaded in their radios. The recommended order of importance to add them is from left to right across the table as room permits.

XECOMM1	8CALL90D	XECOMM17	XLECOMM1	This zone is for
XECOMM2	8TAC91D	XECOMM18	XLECOMM2	your Counties
XECOMM3	8TAC92D	XECOMM19	XLECOMM3	XSOXX talkgroup
XECOMM4	8TAC93D	XECOMM20	XLECOMM4	and the Counties
XECOMM5	8TAC94D	XECOMM21	XLECOMM5	that surround
XECOMM6	8CALL90	XECOMM22	XLECOMM6	your County or
XECOMM7	8TAC91	XECOMM23	XLECOMM7	Counties that you
XECOMM8	8TAC92	XECOMM24	XLECOMM8	regularly work
XECOMM9	8TAC93	XECOMM25	XLECOMM9	with.
XECOMM10	8TAC94	XECOMM26	XLECOMM10	XSO01
XECOMM11	8TAC94D	XECOMM27	XLECOMM11	XSO02
XECOMM12	8TAC93D	XECOMM28	XLECOMM12	XSO03
XECOMM13	8TAC92D	XECOMM29	XLECOMM13	XSO04
XECOMM14	8TAC91D	XECOMM30	XLECOMM14	XSO05
XECOMM15	8CALL90D	XECOMM31	XLECOMM15	XSO06
XECOMM16		XECOMM32	XLECOMM16	XSO07

7.0 Best TalkGroup Plan

If room permits, the complete interoperability template can be loaded into all public safety radios. The recommended order of importance to add them is from left to right across the tables as room permits.

XECOMM1	8CALL90D	XECOMM17	XLECOMM1	This zone is for
XECOMM2	8TAC91D	XECOMM18	XLECOMM2	your Counties
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XECOMM5	8TAC94D	XECOMM21	XLECOMM5	that surround
XECOMM6	8CALL90	XECOMM22	XLECOMM6	your County or
XECOMM7	8TAC91	XECOMM23	XLECOMM7	Counties that you
XECOMM8	8TAC92	XECOMM24	XLECOMM8	regularly work
XECOMM9	8TAC93	XECOMM25	XLECOMM9	with.
XECOMM10	8TAC94	XECOMM26	XLECOMM10	XSO01
XECOMM11	8TAC94D	XECOMM27	XLECOMM11	XSO02
XECOMM12	8TAC93D	XECOMM28	XLECOMM12	XSO03
XECOMM13	8TAC92D	XECOMM29	XLECOMM13	XSO04
XECOMM14	8TAC91D	XECOMM30	XLECOMM14	XSO05
XECOMM15	8CALL90D	XECOMM31	XLECOMM15	XSO06
XECOMM16		XECOMM32	XLECOMM16	XSO07

XMARCS1	XSCOMM1	XSCOMM17	7CALL50	7CALL70
XMARCS2	XSCOMM2	XSCOMM18	7TAC51D	7TAC71D
XMARCS3	XSCOMM3	XSCOMM19	7TAC52D	7TAC72D
XMARCS4	XSCOMM4	XSCOMM20	7TAC53D	7TAC73D
XMARCS5	XSCOMM5	XSCOMM21	7TAC54D	7TAC74D
XMARCS6	XSCOMM6	XSCOMM22	7TAC55D	7TAC75D
XMARCS7	XSCOMM7	XSCOMM23	7TAC56D	7TAC76D
XMARCS8	XSCOMM8	XSCOMM24	7GTAC57D	7TAC77D
XMARCS9	XSCOMM9	XSCOMM25	7MOB59D	7MOB79D
XMARCS10	XSCOMM10	XSCOMM26	7LAW61D	7LAW81D
XMARCS11	XSCOMM11	XSCOMM27	7LAW62D	7LAW82D
XMARCS12	XSCOMM12	XSCOMM28	7FIRE63D	7FIRE83D
XMARCS13	XSCOMM13	XSCOMM29	7FIRE64D	7FIRE84D
XMARCS14	XSCOMM14	XSCOMM30	7MED65D	7MED86D
XMARCS15	XSCOMM15	XSCOMM31	7MED66D	7MED87D
XMARCS16	XSCOMM16	XSCOMM32	7MED66D	7MED87D

8.0 Optional Talkgroups

The following optional talkgroups are available to be included in public safety radios if applicable. **XPURSUIT talkgroups are for Law Enforcement radios only.**

XPURSUIT1	XSFM-HQ	RED EVT
XPURSUIT2	XSFM-OP1	
XPURSUIT3	XSFM-OP2	
XPURSUIT4	XSFM-OP3	
XPURSUIT5	XSFM-OP4	
XPURSUIT6	XSFM-OP5	
XPURSUIT7	XOFCA-1	
XPURSUIT8	XOFCA 2	
	XOSFA 1	

9.0 Effective Date

The current version of this policy was approved and adopted by the MARCS Steering Committee on May 9, 2023.

10.0 Revision History

DATE	Description of Change
07/19/2004	Original Document
02/27/2019	Revised
04/27/2023	Updated for increased number of XECOMM & MARCS talkgroups; added Minimum Interoperability Talkgroup Requirements

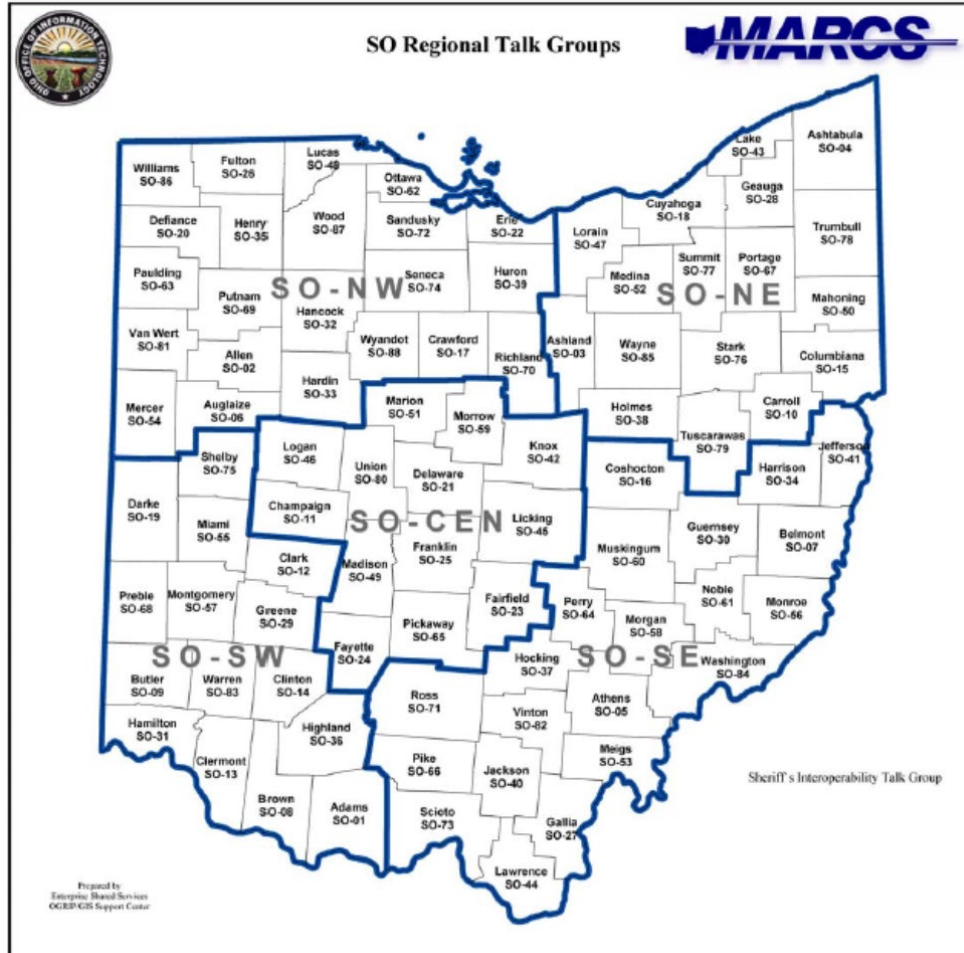
11.0 Attachments

Multi-Agency Radio Communication System (MARCS) Statewide Interoperability Talkgroups (maps and talkgroups lists) (4 pp.)

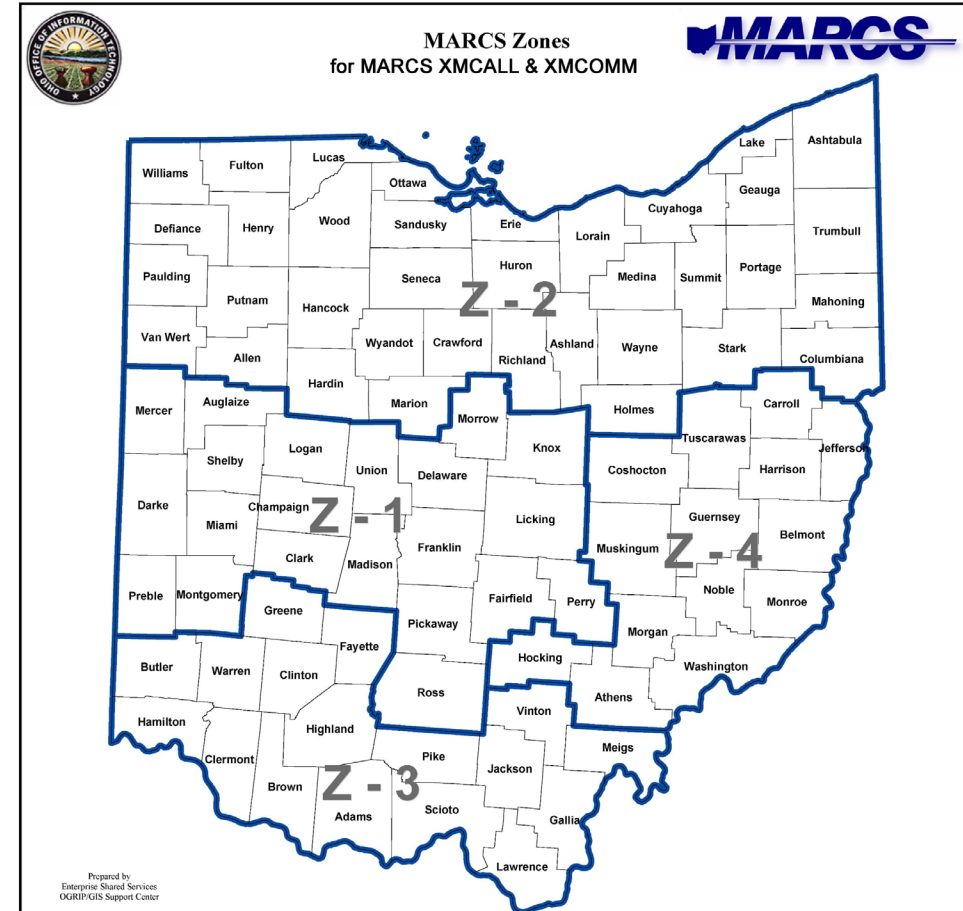
Multi-Agency Radio Communication System (MARCS)

Statewide Interoperability Talkgroups (MPP-15.0)

Sheriff Offices



XMCall & XMComm



MARCS Program Office
4200 Surface Road
Columbus, Ohio 43228

<https://das.ohio.gov/MARCS>
614.995.0060 Telephone
614.995.0067 Fax
866.646.2727 Network Operations/Helpdesk

Multi-Agency Radio Communication System (MARCS)

Statewide Interoperability Talkgroups (MPP-15.0)

- **XMCALL 1 thru 4**
MARCS “Hailing Channel”, Zones 1-4 (see map titled “MARCS Zones”) Allows any user to call for help from anywhere in the state. These talkgroups are monitored 24/7 by all OSHP Posts within the physical limits of each Zone. The talkgroups are also monitored 24/7 by ODNR’s Columbus Central Dispatch. (It is preferred the call be directed to the zone the call originates from but is not required.)
- **XMCOMM 1 thru 4**
MARCS users generic talkgroups for any user to be able to talk to any other user. These talkgroups are NOT monitored by MARCS base locations. Generally, a dispatcher would direct you to “*go to XMCOMM 1 to talk to Officer A,*” etc. (While each XMCOMM has statewide capability, the theoretical purpose is for “direct” communications in each geographic Zone.)
- **XECOMM 1 thru 32**
MARCS users generic “emergency” talkgroups. To be used to talk to any other user when involved in a MARCS-coordinated emergency. At a multi-agency scene, Command/Communications/Control would steer responders to these talkgroups, based on functional work groups. (E.g., A MARCS-equipped CCC would direct “All incoming traffic units go to XECOMM 9”, “all incoming rescue units go to XECOMM 11”, “all incoming hot zone units go to XECOMM12”, etc.) XECOMM 1-19 will be coordinated through the MARCS 24hr Help Desk via **XHELPDSK or (866)-646-2727**. XECOMM 21-28 utilized for Homeland Security Regions 1-8 (HS Region 1 – use XECOMM21). **XECOMM 20 is used for the Ohio Fire Chiefs Emergency Response System & Homeland Security HAILING**
- **XSCOMM 1 thru 16 – TOW 5A1**
These talkgroups are used with the standalone MARCS Tower on Wheels (TOW 5A1). To be used to talk to any other user when involved in an emergency or event *only* when the TOWS are deployed. As with the ECOMMs, units would be “steered” to these talkgroups by state personnel.
XSCOMM 17 thru 32 – TOW 649
These talkgroups are used with TOW 649. See TOW 5A1 definition above,
- **XSO-01 thru XSO-88**
Each Sheriff in the state is equipped with a MARCS base radio. These radios are placed in the communication center of the sheriff’s choice. By calling the alpha-based two-digit county number (e.g., “*GPD Car 321 to SO 59*”), you will be communicating with the Sheriff’s Communication Center. Also, the OSHP post in a county monitors that county’s SO talkgroup and those SO talkgroups of adjacent counties.
- **XSO Regions**
These talkgroups correspond with the geographic regions established by BSSA and MARCS during the planning for the MARCS radio installations at each SO. They follow established Ohio Homeland Security (OHS) boundaries – see attached map titled “Sheriff Offices”. Calling on an SO regional talkgroup will result in all SO’s within that region being hailed. ODNR’s central dispatch center in Columbus also monitors these talkgroups.
- **XLECOMM1 through XLECOMM16**
MARCS users “event/emergency” talkgroups – offers the ability to talk to any other user when involved in a planned event or emergency. (Prior to using, caller must announce intent to use and determine if the talkgroup is already in use. These XLECOMM talkgroups are specifically for “local” event/emergency situations).
- **XHELPDSK**
This talkgroup is constantly monitored by the Ohio Office of Information Technology/MARCS-dedicated Helpdesk, located at the State of Ohio Computer Center in Columbus. The Helpdesk’s primary purpose is to assist MARCS equipment users with problems encountered with the MARCS voice or data systems statewide. It can also be used as the initial point of contact for MARCS command staff. Helpdesk may also be reached 24/7 @ 1-866-OH-MARCS (1-866-646-2727).
- **National Interoperability Channels (i.e., 8CALL90,7CALL,7LAW)**
These are the Nationwide Public Safety Interoperable channels. All of these channels are available for emergency communications. These channels should not be used for daily operations. Channels marked with “D” suffix are radio to radio direct (simplex).
- **XSFM-HQ, SFM-OPS 1-5, OFCA1-2, OSFA-1**
These are mutual aid talkgroups created by the State Fire Marshall and Ohio fire chiefs, respectively for mutual aid purposes during emergencies. Although these are not regularly monitored, they will be assigned by the Incident Commander on site during emergencies and monitored at that time.
- **XMEDVAC1, XMEDFLT, XCAREFLT, XLF-TAC, XCC-AIR, XPTNOPS, XAIREVAC, XMETROLZ, XMETRFCO**
These are talkgroups established for contacting “air ambulances” in Ohio. XMEDFLT (MedFlight Columbus) is monitored by their respective Communications Centers. XMEDVAC1 (MedEvac-Cleveland) and XCAREFLT (CareFlight-Dayton) are not monitored on a daily basis, therefore, it is recommended contact be made via land line with each respective air ambulance. 8TAC92D and 8TAC94D NPSPAC recommended by the helicopter entities as a direct radio air to ground talkpath.
XMARCS 1 thru 16
These are talkgroups established for additional interoperability between MARCS users. They may be used for state or local emergency coordination if desired.
XMARCRPT1 and 2 – These are standalone repeater pairs that are usually patched to a MARCS talkgroup via the BSSA trucks, or the MARCS owned portable repeaters (Battle Packs).
- **XPursuit 1 thru 8 (XPRSUIT)**
Pursuit talkgroups provide the means for first responders to engage in multi-agency/multi-jurisdictional pursuits. These are available at any time without restriction during a pursuit (programmed into Law Enforcement only radios).
- **Customer-Specific Talkgroups**
MARCS will work with each customer to design unique talkgroups to be used by the customer for normal internal traffic. The number of talkgroups allowed is determined by agency scope, size and service delivery.
- **Inter-Agency Talkgroups**
MARCS firmly advocates and aggressively pursues multi-agency sharing of agency specific talkgroups. MARCS encourages agencies to share agency-specific talkgroups, in order to promote user-friendly end-user applications. These become especially important and beneficial in emergency situations, when stress levels are high, and first responders do not have time to “get out the book” and search for little or never used “special” talkgroups. To this end, MARCS encourages users to discuss inter-agency sharing of agency specific talkgroups and the routine use of same!

Multi-Agency Radio Communication System (MARCS)

Statewide Interoperability Talkgroups (MPP-15.0)

Minimum Interoperability talkgroup Requirements

I. Purpose / Objective

To set forth the minimum set of interoperable talkgroups to be required in all **public safety and public works** radios that operate on the State of Ohio MARCS radio system. Existing radios shall be brought into compliance at the next user scheduled radio programming change.

All new radios shall meet the minimum interoperability requirements upon being placed in service.

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II. Background

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III. Radio Capacity

Each zone of Interoperability talkgroups will be ranked into groups and those talkgroups added to the radio after the radio has met any local requirements (i.e., if the radio only has a 48 talkgroup / channel capacity and the local requirement takes 32 talkgroups / channels; the remaining sixteen (16) shall be used for interoperability talkgroups / channels. The location of the interoperability zones in the radio are at the user agencies discretion.

IV. “Must Have” TalkGroups

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XECOMM2	XECOMM6	XECOMM10	XECOMM14
XECOMM3	XECOMM7	XECOMM11	XECOMM15
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All public works radios shall have the following interoperability zone loaded in their radios.

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V. Better TalkGroup Plan

If possible, all public safety radios should have the following “Better” list of interoperability zones loaded in their radios. The recommended order of importance to add them is from left to right across the table as room permits.

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XECOMM14	8TAC91D	XECOMM30	XLECOMM14	XSO05
XECOMM15	8CALL90D	XECOMM31	XLECOMM15	XSO06
XECOMM16		XECOMM32	XLECOMM16	XSO07

Multi-Agency Radio Communication System (MARCS)

Statewide Interoperability Talkgroups (MPP-15.0)

Minimum Interoperability talkgroup Requirements

VI. Best TalkGroup Plan

If room permits, the complete interoperability template can be loaded into all public safety radios. The recommended order of importance to add them is from left to right across the tables as room permits.

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XMARCS11	XSCOMM11	XSCOMM27	7LAW62D	7LAW82D
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XMARCS13	XSCOMM13	XSCOMM29	7FIRE64D	7FIRE84D
XMARCS14	XSCOMM14	XSCOMM30	7MED65D	7MED86D
XMARCS15	XSCOMM15	XSCOMM31	7MED66D	7MED87D
XMARCS16	XSCOMM16	XSCOMM32	7MED66D	7MED87D

VII. Optional talkgroups

The following optional talkgroups are available to be included in public safety radios if applicable. **XPURSUIT talkgroups are for Law Enforcement radios only.**

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XPURSUIT3	XSFM-OP2	
XPURSUIT4	XSFM-OP3	
XPURSUIT5	XSFM-OP4	
XPURSUIT6	XSFM-OP5	
XPURSUIT7	XOFCA-1	
XPURSUIT8	XOFCA 2	
	XOSFA 1	

Revision History

04/27/2023 Updated for increased number of XECOMM & XMARCS talkgroups; added Minimum Interoperability talkgroup Requirements.